

BERNARD KOFI SARPONG

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EMPLOYMENT

National Graduate Institute for Policy Studies (GRIPS), Tokyo, Japan *Apr 2026 – Present*

Research Assistant: Experimental and Behavioural Economics Research

Project: Cognitive imprecision and ageing: experimental investigation of new theories of decision-making

Takushoku University, Faculty of Commerce, Tokyo, Japan *Apr 2026 – Present*

English Lecturer: Basic Business English, Freshman English

Tokyo Global Gateway, Tokyo, Japan *Dec 2022 – Present*

English Instructor: Specialist for active immersion English lessons

National Graduate Institute for Policy Studies, Tokyo, Japan *Dec 2024 – Jul 2025*

Data Science Consultant: Data wrangling, Data visualization, Econometrics, and Machine learning

National Graduate Institute for Policy Studies, Tokyo, Japan *Oct 2023 – Mar 2025*

Teaching Assistant: Graduate-level Microeconomics and International Finance

University of Ghana, Legon, Ghana *Sep 2013 – Sep 2022*

Economics Tutor, School of Continuing and Distance Education

Teaching Assistant, Department of Economics

Republic Bank Ghana PLC, Accra, Ghana *Sep 2016 – Sep 2022*

Economic Intelligence Analyst, Strategic Planning and Research Department

Fixed Income and Money Markets Dealer, Treasury Department

EDUCATION

National Graduate Institute for Policy Studies (GRIPS), Tokyo, Japan *Oct 2022 – Sep 2025*

Ph.D. in Development Economics

Dissertation: *Crisis-Time Exposures and the Persistence of Behavioural Tendencies*

University of Ghana, Legon, Ghana *Sep 2014 – Jul 2016*

Master of Philosophy in Economics

University of Ghana, Legon, Ghana *Aug 2009 – May 2013*

Bachelor of Arts in Economics, *First-Class Honours*

RESEARCH

Fields: Applied Econometrics, Development Economics, Behavioural Economics, Monetary and Financial Economics

Work-in-progress

1. When Prosperity Matters: How Economic Booms Shape Economic Values
2. The Long Shadow of Crises: Do Large Macroeconomic Declines Shape Individual Agency?
3. Institutional Persistence and Beliefs About the Returns to Effort

Working Papers

1. Exposure to Macroeconomic Crises and Risk Preferences
2. Crisis-Time Enfranchisement and the Persistence of Protest Behaviour (with Jun Goto)
3. Macroeconomic Volatility and Online-Gambling Engagement: Evidence from Platform Outages (with Jun Goto)

Published

1. Taylor, D., Sarpong, B., & Cudjoe, E. Y. (2024). Cost-efficiency and bank profitability during health crisis. *Applied Economics Letters*, 31(8), 732-737. Available at <https://doi.org/10.1080/13504851.2022.2146644>
2. Sarpong, B. & Nketiah-Amponsah, E. (2022). Financial Inclusion and Inclusive Growth in Sub-Saharan Africa. *Cogent Economics & Finance*, 10(1). Available at <https://doi.org/10.1080/23322039.2022.2058734>.
3. Taylor, D. & Sarpong, B. (2020). The Impact of Covid-19 Induced Capital Flight on the Bond and Foreign Exchange Markets in Ghana. *International Journal of Developing and Emerging Economies*, 8(2), 1-14. Available at <https://www.eajournals.org/wp-content/uploads/The-Impact-of-Covid-19-Induced-Capital-Flight-on-the-Bond-and-Foreign-Exchange-Markets-In-Ghana.pdf>.
4. Nketiah-Amponsah, E., & Sarpong, B. (2020). Ease of doing business and foreign direct investment: Case of Sub-Saharan Africa. *International Advances in Economic Research*, 26(3), 209-223. Available at <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11294-020-09798-w>.
5. Sarpong, B., Nketiah-Amponsah, E., & Owoo, N. S. (2020). Health and Economic Growth Nexus: Evidence from Selected Sub-Saharan African (SSA) Countries. *Global Business Review*, 21(2), 328–347. Available at <https://doi.org/10.1177/0972150918778966>.
6. Nketiah-Amponsah, E. & Sarpong, B. (2019). Effect of Infrastructure and Foreign Direct Investment on Economic Growth in Sub-Saharan Africa. *Global Journal of Emerging Market Economies*, 11(3), 183-201. Available at <https://doi.org/10.1177/0974910119887242>.

Publication Metrics: <https://scholar.google.com/citations?user=cbKK6DAAAAAJ&hl=en&oi=ao>

REFEREEING

Economic Letters; Applied Economics Journal; International Journal of Social Economics; Journal of Financial Economic Policy; Journal of Economic Studies; The Journal of International Trade & Economic Development; International Journal of Emerging Markets; Ghanaian Journal of Economics

SEMINARS AND CONFERENCES

Conference Assistant, GRIPS Jun 2025

The Tokyo Conference on Institutions, Law, and Development (Tokyo ILD)

Presenter, GRIPS Graduate Seminars Oct 2023 – May 2025

Paper 1: Exposure to Macroeconomic Crises and Risk Preferences

Paper 2: Crisis-Time Enfranchisement and the Persistence of Protest Behaviour

Conference Assistant, SEEDEC, GRIPS Sep 2023

Symposium on Economic Experiments in Developing Countries (SEEDC)

AWARDS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

Japanese Government MEXT Scholarship Oct 2022 – Sep 2025

To pursue Ph.D. in Development Economics at GRIPS

Tony & Awele Elumelu Prize, Tony Elumelu Foundation Nov 2015

Best Graduating Master of Philosophy Student in Economics, University of Ghana

Kenneth Dadzie Memorial Education Trust Fund Scholarship, Standard Chartered Bank Nov 2015

To pursue MPhil. Economics at the University of Ghana

Republic Bank (Ghana) PLC

Most Improved Employee Engagement, Strategic Planning and Research Dept. 2021

First Runner Up, Most Improved Specialised Unit, Strategic Planning and Research Dept. 2021

First Runner Up, Best Customer Service Specialised Unit, Strategic Planning and Research Dept. 2021

Managing Director's commendation for exceeding expectations, Treasury Dept. 2018

SKILLS

Data Science & Analytics: Data analysis, data wrangling, data visualisation, econometric modelling, forecasting, machine learning, web scraping, workflow automation.

Programming & Analytical Tools: Stata, Python, Claude Code, Jupyter Notebook, SQL*, Excel Analytics

Languages: English (Fluent), Spanish (Intermediate), French (Beginner), Twi (Native), Ga (Native)